CASE STUDY #7 — TELECOM

5G Enterprise B2B Monetization Strategy

Introduction

The client is a leading pan-India telecom operator that has completed its 5G rollout across 500+ cities. Consumer 5G adoption is growing, but ARPU gains have plateaued because rivals offer near-identical consumer plans.

Background

Management believes the larger untapped opportunity lies in enterprise (B2B) 5G use cases — private networks, network slicing, and IoT connectivity — but the client has no established enterprise go-to-market motion and limited experience selling to industrial customers. The CFO wants a monetization roadmap before competitors capture large anchor accounts.

Approach: Use-Case Prioritization Framework

Enterprise 5G use cases were prioritized on two axes: revenue potential (deal size, recurring revenue, cross-sell) and feasibility (technical readiness, sales-cycle length, capital intensity).

- **Manufacturing Private 5G Networks:** high revenue potential and moderate feasibility — factories need low-latency, secure connectivity for robotics and AGVs, but sales cycles run 9–12 months.
- **Smart Logistics & Fleet IoT:** high feasibility, moderate revenue — leverages existing IoT SIM infrastructure and sells faster, though with smaller deal sizes.
- **Healthcare Remote Diagnostics:** high revenue potential, low near-term feasibility — requires ultra-reliable low-latency slicing and regulatory clearance.
- **Smart City / Utility Grids:** government-anchored, moderate revenue, long procurement cycles — valuable for reference customers rather than near-term revenue.

Recommended Rollout & Expected Impact

- **Horizon 1 (0–12 months):** monetize smart logistics and fleet IoT using existing infrastructure to generate quick, referenceable wins.
- **Horizon 2 (12–24 months):** build a dedicated enterprise sales pod and land 3–5 anchor manufacturing private-network deals to prove the model.
- **Horizon 3 (24+ months):** scale into healthcare and smart-city verticals once network-slicing SLAs and regulatory pathways mature.

Final Note

Sequencing the roadmap this way converts 5G capex into enterprise revenue faster than a simultaneous multi-vertical push, since each horizon's reference customers de-risk the next.

Questions for Discussion

- How should the client structure sales incentives differently for enterprise deals versus its existing consumer sales motion?
- What capabilities does the operator need to build in-house versus partner for (e.g., systems integrators for private networks)?
- How can the client defend this enterprise revenue once competitors replicate the same use-case roadmap?